

Internal SSDs

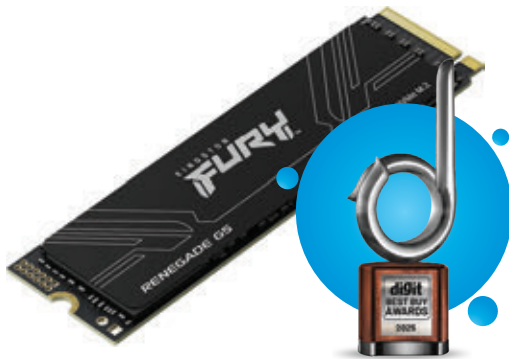
High speed storage for every build

The internal SSD market in 2025 has moved toward PCIe 5.0 for high end builds, while PCIe 4.0 remains the sweet spot for affordable systems. Since early 2025, capacities have grown, controllers have become more efficient and heatsinks have evolved to manage the heavier thermal load of next gen speeds. For gamers, creators and workstation users, storage now matters as much to system responsiveness as the CPU or GPU. Vendors are also focusing on consistency over peak numbers, with better thermal solutions, smarter firmware and tuning for mixed workloads, all of which shape how fast a system feels in real use.

Zero1 winner: WD_BLACK SN8100 NVMe SSD

The WD_BLACK SN8100 SSD takes the Zero1 Award by delivering top tier speed and consistency for high end systems. In our tests, this PCIe 5.0 drive led both synthetic and real world workloads, from large game libraries to chunky 4K projects. It also scaled well at higher queue depths, maintaining performance even under heavy parallel transfers and background tasks, which mirrors a modern gaming or streaming PC.

Thermals were impressively stable for a PCIe 5.0 drive. With a good motherboard heatsink, the SN8100 sustained high write speeds for long stretches before throttling, and random access stayed quick even during extended stress tests. Level loads, open world streaming and switching between heavy creative apps felt instant.



Kingston FURY Renegade G5 NVMe SSD
Price: ₹16,680



WD_BLACK SN8100 NVMe SSD
Price: ₹17,399

Runner-up: Crucial T710 NVMe SSD

Crucial's T710 NVMe SSD takes the runner up spot, often matching or closely trailing the WD_BLACK SN8100 in several tests. It posted excellent sequential read speeds and felt snappy in daily use, from Windows boots to reopening heavy creator projects. In game load tests, it stayed near the top, making it a strong choice for asset heavy titles that need fast streaming.

The T710 slipped a bit in the longest sustained write tests and heavily mixed workloads, where the SN8100's tuning held an advantage. Even so, its mix of strong performance, good thermals and smooth firmware behaviour makes it a compelling choice for enthusiasts who want serious speed without going all in on a no compromise flagship.



Crucial T710 NVMe SSD
Price: ₹19,999

Best Buy: Kingston FURY Renegade G5 NVMe SSD

The Kingston FURY Renegade G5 SSD wins the Best Buy award for offering the strongest performance per rupee in this year's lineup. It does not hit the absolute peak numbers of the Zero1 winner, but it came impressively close in many real world tests, especially game loads and common creator workflows. For most, the gap in everyday feel between this drive and the pricier flagships is small, which makes it such a standout value.

Kingston tuned the FURY Renegade G5 for consistency, and it showed in our tests. Performance held steady once transfers moved beyond cache limits, and random reads and writes stayed responsive even with scans, updates and backups running. That blend of speed, stable thermals and low cost is what secured its Best Buy title this year.

— Mithun Mohandas | editor@digit.in